

2e. Subject content for components H409/01 and H409/02

The following subject content outlines the knowledge and understanding that underpins this qualification.

The subject content will be assessed across all components. For the examined components (01 and

02), this will be assessed in relation to the relevant set of media products as indicated.

Subject Content		
Topic	Key Idea	Learners must have studied
Contexts of Media	Social, cultural, political, economic and historical contexts.	• how the media products studied differ in institutional backgrounds and use of media language to create meaning and construct representations to reach different audiences, and can act as a means of: - reflecting social, cultural and political attitudes towards wider issues and beliefs - constructing social, cultural and political attitudes towards wider issues and beliefs • how media products studied can act as a means of reflecting historical issues and events • how media products studied can potentially be an agent in facilitating social, cultural and political developments through the use of media language to construct meaning through viewpoints, messages and values and representations of events and issues • how media products studied are influenced by social, cultural, political and historical contexts through intertextual references • how media products studied reflect their economic contexts through production, financial and technological opportunities and constraints.
Media Language	How the media through their forms ¹ , codes, conventions and techniques communicate meanings.	• how the different modes² and language³ associated with different media forms communicate multiple meanings • how the combination of elements of media language influence meaning • how developing technologies affect media language

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		- the codes and conventions of media forms and products, including the processes through which media language develops as genre - the dynamic and historically relative nature of genre - the processes through which meanings are established through intertextuality - how audiences respond to and interpret the above aspects of media language. - how genre conventions are socially and historically relative, dynamic and can be used in a hybrid way - the significance of challenging and/or subverting genre conventions - the significance of the varieties of ways in which intertextuality can be used in the media - the way media language incorporates viewpoints and ideologies.
	Theories of media language.	- semiotics, including Barthes - narratology, including Todorov - genre theory, including Neale - structuralism, including Lévi-Strauss - postmodernism, including Baudrillard.